

DHAVAL KADAKIA

FP&A Lead | CMA | Finance Transformation Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven FP&A & Business Performance leader with 18+ years of progressive experience across Fortune 500 companies (BP, Maersk, Volkswagen). CMA-qualified finance professional with a strong track record in strategic budgeting, forecasting, financial modelling, and process automation — delivering 25% faster month-end close cycles and \$2.5M+ in cost savings. Expertise in translating complex financial data into executive-level insights that drive informed decision-making.

18+ Years

Experience

25% Faster

Close Cycles

\$2.5M+

Cost Savings

15 Entities

Managed

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

bp (British Petroleum) | FP&A Business Performance Advisor

Jun 2025 – Present | Pune, India

- Drive business performance management through financial analysis, insights, and decision support for senior stakeholders, enabling disciplined and informed decision-making.
- Provide CAPEX support, including evaluation of capital expenditure options and governance-aligned recommendations.
- Support planning, forecasting, and reporting cycles, contributing to quarterly outlooks, actuals analysis, and executive-level management review packs.
- Act as a finance business partner across governance forums and cadence reviews, ensuring alignment, transparency, and accountability across cross-functional teams.
- Lead process improvement and standardization initiatives, including development and maintenance of FP&A models and tools in Power BI and financial modelling in Excel.
- Conduct variance analysis on key financial metrics, delivering actionable insights and commentaries to senior management for strategic decision-making.

Maersk Global Service | Area Finance Controller

Oct 2017 – Jun 2025 | Pune, India

Financial Close & Reporting (Managed 15 entities)

- Executed month-end and year-end close processes for 15 entities ensuring on-time delivery and accurate financial statement preparation in accordance with IFRS.
- Prepared and published monthly financial statements, MIS reports, and executive dashboards.
- Coordinated statutory audits for 15 entities achieving 100% compliance within stipulated timelines; presented financials to Board of Directors and CFO.
- Managed balance sheet reconciliations and account analysis using BlackLine; achieved zero audit findings for 3 consecutive years.

Financial Controls & Compliance

- Reviewed and approved 100+ controls across Archer System ensuring regulatory compliance and internal control effectiveness.
- Ensured 100% compliance with local & state reporting requirements including WHT, VAT, advance taxes, and CIT filings.
- Researched and implemented new accounting standards ensuring seamless adoption and regulatory compliance.

Finance Transformation & Automation

- Led finance transformation initiatives reducing manual effort by 25% through process automation and standardization.
- Collaborated with IT on SAP S/4 HANA enterprise implementation; served as Agile coach guiding 50+ team members through digital transformation.
- Identified and implemented process improvements across SG&A analysis, vendor payment processing, and ad hoc reporting.

- Established controls framework and standardized reconciliation procedures across all 15 entities, reducing close cycle by 1 day.

Financial Analysis & Strategic Support

- Conducted SG&A variance analysis identifying \$500K+ cost optimization opportunities.
- Prepared operational reports and KPI dashboards for senior management tracking performance against \$50M+ annual budgets.
- Analysed financial performance trends identifying areas for process improvement and cost reduction initiatives.

Volkswagen India Pvt. Ltd. | Senior Manager, Finance – Controlling & FP&A

Jan 2008 – Oct 2017 | Pune, India

Strategic Planning & Budgeting

- Prepared 5-year rolling financial plans and annual budgets aligned with plant strategic objectives supporting \$1B+ manufacturing operations (inventory, logistics costs, and indirect labour).
- Developed monthly forecasts and KPI dashboards presented to CFO and Board of Directors highlighting performance against targets.
- Prepared comprehensive business cases for major projects including cost-benefit analysis, CVP analysis, and make-or-buy evaluations supporting \$30M+ capital decisions.

Financial Management & Controls

- Executed month-end and year-end close processes including journals, data analysis, integrity checks, and financial summaries under IFRS.
- Managed internal and statutory audits independently ensuring 100% compliance with regulatory requirements: zero audit exceptions for 5 consecutive years.
- Ensured all departments operate within budgets through rigorous approval of purchase requisitions and budget oversight.
- Customized product costing and invoicing systems from Germany headquarters to suit local accounting and tax requirements.

Process Improvement & SAP Implementation

- Drove process automation reducing month-end close timeline by 25% (from 12 days to 9 days) through standardization and system optimization.
- Served as SAP ERP Super User during enterprise-wide implementation; customized processes to optimize system utilization and user adoption.
- Led continuous improvement initiatives in reporting processes and project-based financial analysis.

Team Leadership & Development

- Built and led high-performing finance teams of 8+ professionals through talent acquisition, training programs, and performance coaching.
- Conducted regular performance appraisals and mentoring for direct reports driving performance improvement and career advancement.
- Facilitated team workshops aligning teams on strategic goals and process improvements.

Electronic Data Systems (HP) | Financial Analyst, FP&A

Jan 2007 – Jan 2008 | Pune, India

- Transitioned FP&A role from Australia to India, establishing financial processes, reporting standards, and KPI frameworks.
- Prepared annual budgets, quarterly forecasts, and monthly/quarterly variance explanations supporting \$50M+ cost centre portfolio.
- Provided variance analysis and financial insights to business leaders in monthly corporate close meetings.
- Processed month-end close journal entries in SAP; prepared and analysed balance sheet reconciliations ensuring data integrity.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

2015	CMA (Certified Management Accountant), <i>Institute of Management Accountants (IMA), USA</i>
2003	Master of Commerce (M.Com) - Cost and Works Accounting, <i>University of Pune</i>
2001	Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com) - Cost and Works Accounting, <i>University of Pune</i>

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

ERP Systems SAP ERP SAP S/4 HANA (Super User)	Business Intelligence Power BI Think-cell	Financial Controls Archer GRC BlackLine OneStream
Advanced Excel Power Pivot Pivot Tables Financial Modeling	Collaboration Tools Microsoft 365 Suite SharePoint Teams	Methodologies Agile/Scrum (Certified Coach). Continuous Improvement
Accounting Standards IFRS		

LANGUAGES

English Native/Fluent (Professional Working Proficiency)	Hindi Upper Intermediate (Full Professional Proficiency)	Marathi Intermediate (Limited Working Proficiency)	Gujarati Elementary (Elementary Proficiency)
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KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

Finance Transformation Excellence

Led automation initiatives reducing manual efforts and month-end close cycle by 25% (from 4 to 3 days)

Audit Findings

Managed financial controls and reconciliations for 15 entities achieving no major audit findings throughout the tenure.

Cost Optimization

Drove SG&A cost-saving initiatives via variance analysis and process optimization, delivering \$500K+ savings at Maersk and \$2M+ at Volkswagen

SAP Implementation Leadership

Served as SAP Super User and Agile coach during S/4 HANA transformation guiding 50+ team members through change

Team Development

Built and mentored high-performing finance teams driving capability enhancement and career progression